But Now Is Christ Risen

1 Corinthians 15:12-22 (KJV)

Scripture

1 Corinthians 15:12-22

12 Now if Christ be preached that he rose from the dead, how say some among you that there is no
resurrection of the dead? 13 But if there be no resurrection of the dead, then is Christ not risen: 14 And if
Christ be not risen, then is our preaching vain, and your faith is also vain. 15 Yea, and we are found false
witnesses of God; because we have testified of God that he raised up Christ: whom he raised not up, if so be
that the dead rise not. 16 For if the dead rise not, then is not Christ raised: 17 And if Christ be not raised, your
faith is vain; ye are yet in your sins. 18 Then they also which are fallen asleep in Christ are perished. 19 If in
this life only we have hope in Christ, we are of all men most miserable. 20 But now is Christ risen from the
dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept. 21 For since by man came death, by man came also the
resurrection of the dead. 22 For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive.

Outline

1. If Christ is not raised, everything collapses

If Christ be not risen, then is our preaching _____.

If Christ be not raised, ye are yet in your _____.

Read: 1 Corinthians 15:12-19; Romans 4:25; Acts 17:31

2. But now is Christ risen

But now is Christ _____ from the dead.

Christianity rests on an _____ in history.

Read: 1 Corinthians 15:20; Luke 24:1-8; 1 Corinthians 15:3-8

3. The firstfruits: death is not the end

Christ is become the _____ of them that slept.

As in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made _____.

Read: 1 Corinthians 15:20-22; John 11:25-26; 1 Thessalonians 4:13-14

Discussion questions

1. Why does Paul say we would be "most miserable" if our hope in Christ were for this life only?

2. Why does it matter that the resurrection was bodily, not just spiritual?

3. What does "firstfruits" tell us about our own future?

4. How should the resurrection change the way Christians grieve?

This week

Think of one fear or grief that the resurrection speaks to. Write 1 Corinthians 15:20 on a card and put it where you will see it daily. This week, tell someone why you believe Jesus rose from the dead.